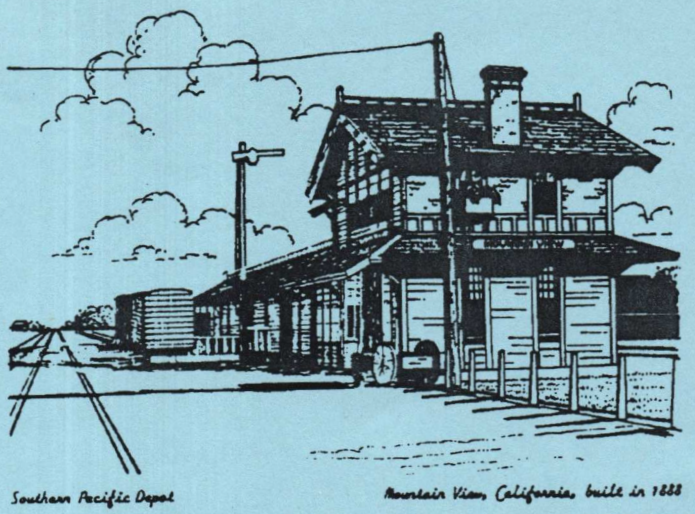
# Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor




## Prunes and Apricots Agriculture in Santa Clara Valley The Sunsweet Story

### Presented by Mr. Richard Azevedo

### The May Meeting

The May 2, 2004 meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association will be back at the Adobe Building, Moffett Blvd. and Central Expressway. The speaker will be Mr. Richard Azevedo.

Mr. Richard Azevedo's family and forebears were pioneers in raising prunes in Santa Clara Valley. Mr. Azevedo spent 39 years with the prune cooperative, eventually as a member of management of Sunsweet Growers in San Jose and Yuba City. He will discuss the growth of the industry, the establishment of the farmers cooperatives such as Sunsweet, the changes that occurred over the years including the decline of the orchard period in Santa Clara Valley with the growth of World War II and the computer industries forcing the movement to other areas in California such as the Sacramento and San Joaquin Valleys.

Join us for snacks and fellowship after the formal meeting.

## Silicon Valley

### Presented By Mr. David A. Laws

### The February Meeting

The February, 2004 General Meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association was held in the in the Mountain View Library Community Room. Mayor Matt Pear, Past Mayor Mike Kasperzak and Council member Nick Galiotto were recognized. New member Peggy Crowder and guest Dave Nakamura were introduced. Life member certificates were presented to Nick and Rebecca Galiotto and to David Greene, Anthony Radisich and Marion Reginato.

Programs and Publicity Chair Wally Erichsen introduced Mr. David A. Laws, our guest speaker. Mr. Laws talk was based upon his photo essay and guide to Santa Clara Valley landscape and communities. Copies of Mr. Laws book were made available for sale, and a copy of the booklet is available in the History Center.

Around 40 people attended the meeting, and Mr. Laws presentation was very well received.

### Save the Date!

Sunday, August 1, 2004 is the date for the Eleventh Annual MVHA Barbecue.

# Old Newspaper Items Compiled By Barbara Kinchen

***125 Years Ago (1879):*** A steamboat carrying passengers ran daily between Alviso and San Francisco.

***100 Years Ago (1904):*** Frank Bacon, actor, has purchased an orchard near Mountain View.

The Alta Mesa Company, organized to found a cemetery to serve Palo Alto, Mayfield and Mountain View, has bought 30 acres on Arastradero Road.

***75 Years Ago (1929):*** Foundations have been laid for a $20,000 building at the corner of Hope and Dana Streets to house the Telephone Company's dial system equipment.

Dedication of the new Highway Grammar School was held in the auditorium. After musical numbers and speeches by Roger Sherman, Board of Trustee President, and Kenneth Slater, Principal, visitors were taken on tours.

The telephone operator can alert the night policeman by ringing the phone on a power pole at Castro and Villa streets, which will now turn on a newly-installed red signal light high above the intersection.

Dr. H.W. Milo will continue his private practice, but sold his interest in the Mountain View Hospital to Mrs. Elsie Fisk and Mrs. Vera Grant, registered nurses. The hospital on El Camino Real near Castro Street, will now be available for all physicians and their patients.

Wally Sohler, Mountain View's star baseball pitcher, is being wooed by both Turlock and Sonora.

The Blue Bird Beauty Parlor offers permanent waves, including shampoo and setting for $6.00, and has a new machine called a "reducer and health belt" which you may try, without charge, before buying "Treatment Cards."

Classes for Whisman School students are being held in the basement of St. Joseph's Catholic Church after a fire destroyed the school on Stierlin Road. The church's school bus is used for transportation.

Postmaster Frank Huff says that "Frank Bacon is the most illustrious citizen we ever had in the community and it is high time we took steps to honor his memory." (Frank Bacon died in 1922) Huff is trying to get the State Automobile Association to erect signs directing people to Baconia, the Bacon home on Berry Road, and he thinks tat Gray Line sightseeing tours should include this house.

***50 Years Ago (1954):*** Palo Alto Consumers Cooperative Society has a building under construction at El Camino and San Antonio Road. (This was the first business in what is now San Antonio Shopping Center.)

New on Castro Street: the Lawson, Campen, Martinez building at 376-380-384, to be occupied by Lawson Real Estate and Insurance Agency, Pep Martinez Barber Shop and Malovos, Mager, Newcomer and Chasuk, attorneys.

Mountain View Union High School graduates were recognized. James B. Bakotich, Class of 1927, Assistant Vice President in the loan supervision department at Bank of America in San Francisco since 1950, goes to Porterville as Bank Manager. Richard Glyer, Jr., Class of 1929, will direct "The Tempest", this year's production in the Mt. Tamalpais amphitheatre.

Over 900 children participated in the annual Easter Egg Hunt, sponsored by the Lions Club and City Recreation Department.

Short Council Term! Within one month Arthur A. Excell was elected, sworn in and resigned. It was ruled that he could not serve as councilman and receive his pension as retired Chief of Police.

Homes were available in two new subdivisions. Yorkshire Homes, near Moffett Boulevard and Bayshore Highway had 10 three bedroom houses at $8,000 while Eldora Park Subdivision listed homes $14,550 to $14,800. These were on Eldora Drive, but eventually there would be over 50 built on nearby streets.

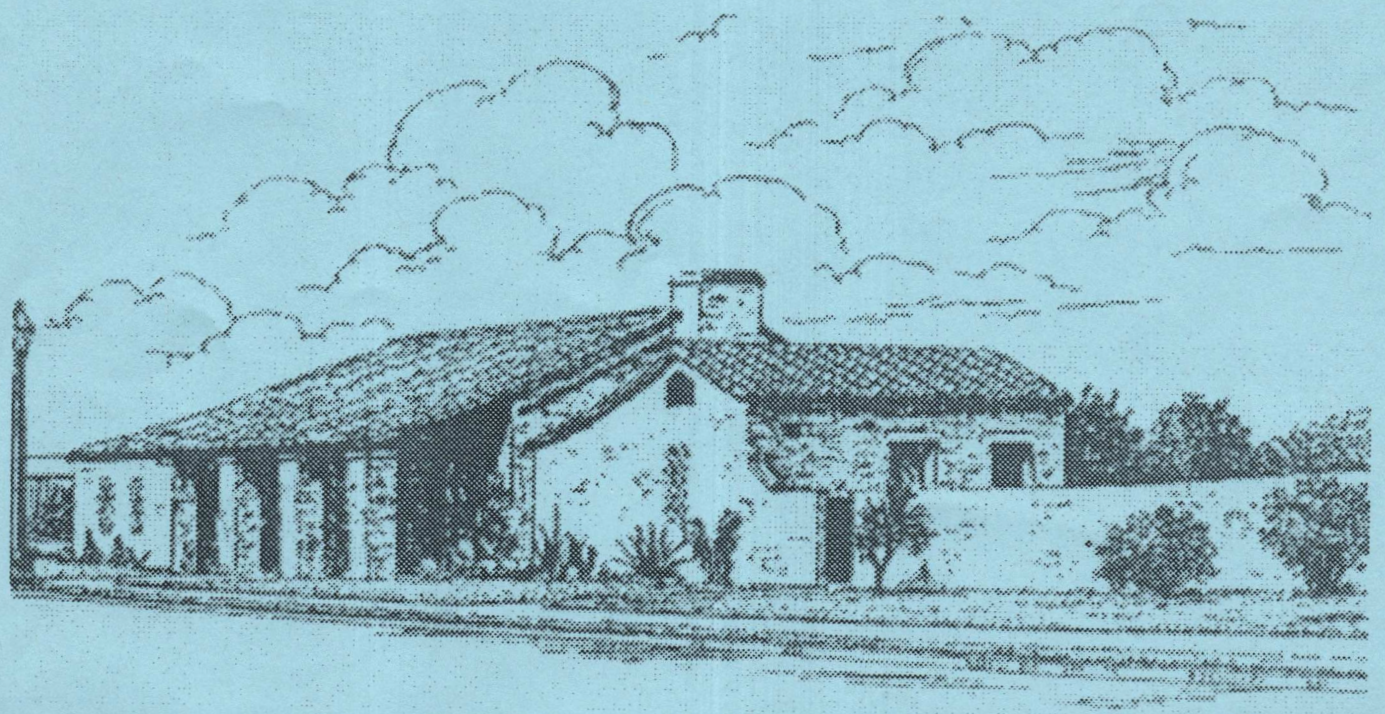
# New to the Mountain View History Center
## By Barbara Kinchen

***From Member Lennart Ahlkvist of Sonora:*** A small packet of gummed "VIA AIR MAIL" labels which were purchased at Wagner's Rexall Drug Store. For over eighty years the family owned and operated the business. First at #198 Castro, then at #340 Castro beginning in 1960. It combined with Knight's in1988, at Hope and Dana Streets.

***From Member Lou Beck of Fresno:*** A 1934 photo of the Shell Oil Depot crew, Manuel Esparenza, Jack Tutman and Louis Beck, Lou's father, and a short write-up about the plant at Evelyn and Calderon. Also, four enlargements of athletic team photos from Mountain View Union High School yearbooks. The football, baseball and soccer teams from the 1925 Blue and Gray include Lou's father as well as the father of our member, Chris Castro.

***From Member Patricia Snow of Fremont:*** Patricia has been researching for many years her Klein family and has presented the room with a copy of her newly-published book. Her father was a son of Pierre Klein, famous for his wines, produced on Montebello Road. Miss Victorine Klein, first grade teacher at Dana Street School, was a daughter of Pierre Klein.

***From Mr. David A. Laws:*** Mr Laws was the speaker at the February 2004 meeting of the Historical Association. He based his talk on his 31 page booklet, "Exploring the Communities Behind the Digital Revolution - A Souvenir and Guide". The booklet is filled with excellent colored photos and interesting facts.



## Street Talk
## By Barbara Kinchen

The February (2004) *Street Talk* question was: True or False: Peacock Avenue was named for the farm where peacocks were raised in the late 1980s for their feathers. And the answer is:

Peacock Avenue is in the Rex Manor area and runs between Farley and Burgoyne. Nothing has ever shown up about Mr. Alison Peacock ever raising peacocks on the 90 acre ranch shown on the 1929 map. Children perhaps, but not birds.

***New Question:*** That part of Dana Street between Bush Street and Calderon carried a different name at one time. Does anyone know what that was?

## President's Message

My message is to each one of you who is reading this. Presently we have two unfilled offices; we need to find a newsletter editor and a treasurer. The duties of the treasurer and the newsletter editor for the MVHA are presently being handled on an ad hoc basis while we search for volunteers to fill these vacancies.

Help us find a member or potential member who could fill either of these needs or volunteer yourself. Responding to this plea does not commit you to accepting the job. We can assure you of adequate help in breaking in to the responsibility and willingness to discuss the various aspects and requirements for the job.

Please call me at (650) 967-2074 if you can help.

Craig Holden, President

## Mountain View Historical Association 1954 - 2004 Golden Anniversary

On September 9, 1954, five people met for the purpose of organizing a group to preserve the history of Mountain View. The five people at that meeting were Eleanor Dale, who let the group, Elizabeth Forbes, Eldora McCarty, Irma Winter and Marie Hugo. The found others in the community who shared their concern and soon established the Mountain View Pioneer and Historical Association. Today we, as the Mountain View Historical Association, carry on with the same objectives as our predecessors. MVHA performs a valuable service to our community by collecting, publishing and preserving the wide range of information and other items that preserve the heritage of our community from its early days to the present.



## Membership Report
## June Casey

Dues are $ 7.00 per year for an individual or $ 10.00 per year for a family membership. Life memberships are available for $ 100.00 per person.

| | |
|---|---|
| Life Members | 114 |
| Honored Member | 1 |
| Annual Memberships | 263 |
| Total Memberships | 378 |

## Association Officers And Executive Committee

| | |
|---|---|
| President | Craig Holden |
| Past President & Social | Ralph Faravelli |
| Vice President | Pat Figueroa |
| Sergeant At Arms | John Viscovich |
| Secretary | Margaret Peterson |
| Editor | Hilton Brown |
| Membership | June Casey |
| Programs and Publicity | Wally Erichsen |
| Hospitality | Elizabeth Engberg |
| Memorial/Remembrance | Edna Thompson |
| Ways & Means | Hip Telmont |
| Historical Data | Barbara Kinchen |
| Amplification/Recording | Albert Jehning |

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting.

## Life, Honored and Special Members

*Honored Member*
Chris Castro

*Life Members*

O. Lennart Ahlkvist
Mario Ambra
J. Paul Arata
May E. Armanini
John Arrillaga
Marge Hingsberger Bailey
Godfrey Baumgartner
Barbara M. Bonetti
Robert J. Bonetti
Flora T. Brown
Hilton U. Brown, III
Laura Withrow Brown
Mary Ann Meek Buswell
Victor Calvo
Alice Churin Carvo
June Casey
William A. Dale
June Redwine de Larios
Cliff Del Carlo
Joseph Diaz
Kevin C. Duggan
Ruth Erichsen
Wallace J. Erichsen
Carmen Faravelli
Ralph Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Tom Frankum
Janice Mae Frankum
Nicholas B. Galiotto
Rebecca J. Galiotto
David O. Greene
Marion Grimm
Valerie E. Harris
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Edward Henderson
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson
Charles Hirschbek
John L. Hirshbek
Norene Hogle
Audrey Jarvis Hoke
Craig Holden
Marjorie Holden
George Holden
Donald M. Holt
Virginia M. Holt
Harold Jarvis
Al Jehning
Leo E. Kalcic
R. Michael Kasperzak Jr.
Diane M. Keenan
Robert W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Barbara Krzyczkowska
Holly Urban Moore Leonard
Madeline Chargon Malovos
Thomas E. Miller
Frances Churin Mills
Betty C. Monroe
Gail Urban Moore
LaVerna Vincent Morgan
Mimi Mourkas
Don Newfarmer
Anne G. Nichols
Nancy Noe
Dana A. Peak
Matt Pear
Richard J. Peery
Harry Pinto
Ida Pinto
Milan Popovich
Massimo Prati
John P. Puppo
Edward L. Puppo
Anthony J. Radisich
Marion R. Reginato
Louis F. Renner
Patricia J. Reyburn
Dorothy Holden Rich
Mark Rogge
Vivian Schatz
Robert C. Schick
Jamil Shaikh
Eugene D. Sharp
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Margaret Garliepp Sideroff
Nancy L. Smith
Richard M. Smith
Jim Spangler
Martin J. Spangler
Austin Spencer
Honor Spitz
Brigitte Stafford
J. R. Stafford
H. Lee Stillens
Jane Culver Stoecklin
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Sally Moore Taboada
H. (Hip) A. Telmont
Charles Thompson
Edna Thompson
John Viscovich
Arthur Walton
Patricia Walton
Paula Weaver
Robert Weaver
Denise Williams
Bill Wissel
Cornelia Matijasevich Whitlow
Lorraine A. Wormald
Mary Lou Zoglin

# MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

## *REGULAR MEETING*

MR. RICHARD AZEVEDO
PRESENTING

## *PRUNES AND APRICOTS*
## *THE SUNSWEET STORY*
## *AGRICULTURE IN SANTA CLARA VALLEY*

**SUNDAY, MAY 2, 2004**
**2:00 P.M.**

**THE ADOBE BUILDING**
**MOFFETT BLVD AND CENTRAL EXPRESSWAY**

**MEMBERSHIP:** Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

**AIMS:** The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

### MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

*TYPE:* NEW____ RENEWAL____

Regular Member $ 7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr
Life Member $100.00.

*Make Check Payable to:*

Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

MOUNTAIN VIEW
HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. BOX 252
MOUNTAIN VIEW, CA 94042

MOUNTAIN VIEW CA APR 20'04 PB METER 8350491 ≈ 0.37 ≈ U.S. POSTAGE

FIRST CLASS MAIL

